

PLOT SUMMARY

Nature is a mythic musical about Mother Nature and her second child deciding whether to save the last human or to leave her to perish as atonement for the species killing Nature's firstborn.

Long ago, the original Mother Nature and her child roamed the cosmos. While exploring the Solar System, Child Nature created the Earth ("[Mom, I Made Earth](#)"). Over many generations, the children would draw flora and fauna, and the Mothers would bring them to life. The thirteenth generation created humanity. As humans grew and fought, the global War to End All Life erupted. True Nature tried to intervene against Mother Nature's warnings and was killed by humanity ("[In My Image](#)").

Millennia after the fall of humanity, Mother Nature conceives a new heir, Second Nature. Alongside their shapeshifting pet, Good Nature, they restore extinct species like dodos ("[Another Chance](#)"). While playing fetch in Australia, Good Nature gets caught in a trap set by Imara Truth, the last surviving human. Second chases Imara until she frees the pet. Second tells Mother Nature about Imara. Mother recalls drawing the species and warns of their inherent cruelty ("[Truth Be Told](#)"), making Second promise never to redraw them. Later, Second tries to trap Imara but activates a war-robot. Imara saves Second's life, teaching them about human empathy ("[Homos Got Morals](#)"). Second decides to help Imara prepare to meet Mother Nature. Good Nature leads Mother Nature to their hiding spot, triggering a confrontation. Mother realizes she cannot instinctively track Imara like she tracks all other living things ("[Give Me a Second](#)").

Out of gratitude for saving Second, Mother Nature spares Imara on the condition she agrees to live out her days and let humanity go extinct. She tasks Second with showing Imara the world. In the ruins of New York City, Imara finds a functional fertility clinic and uses it to become pregnant. Sensing the new human life, Mother Nature intervenes, dragging Second away and leaving Imara to die in the Sahara Desert ("[A Nice Run](#)").

Months go by, and Second decides to rescue Imara, who is somehow surviving the desert. While Good Nature distracts Mother, Second and Imara flee across the globe. Mother relentlessly pursues the pair, finally cornering them in an ancient city. Second argues their older sibling died trying to save humanity out of love, not hatred. Harming Imara and her child would mean True's sacrifice was for nothing. Refusing to listen, Mother Nature shoves Imara into a statue holding a spear, impaling her. As Imara dies, the spirit of True Nature emerges from her body, revealing that True had been reincarnated within the human line.

True did not die for humanity. True became part of humanity. Mother realizes she has killed her firstborn a second time ("Truth Be Bold").

Eras pass. Second Nature matures into the new Mother Nature and conceives her own child. The musical ends as this new child begins drawing humans once again, proving that life always finds a way back. In the end, a human resembling Imara explores the new world with her child ("Life Goes Out, Light Stays On")

Science educator David Quang Pham spotlights replacement child syndrome, the duality of humanity for love and hate, and grief by exploring nature and evolution.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

MOTHER NATURE XIII, older adult deity, the mother of True and Second. She commands the flora and fauna of the land, air, and sea. As a kid, she drew humans which her mother created in her image. After twelve generations of Mother Natures, she is the thirteenth. She is the only Mother to ever lose her heir before her own passing. So, she is overprotective, distrustful, and intelligent. Her performer can double as **MOTHER NATURE I - XII**.

TRUE NATURE, child deity, Mother's Nature firstborn who perished trying to thwart humanity's War to End All Life. Their performer can double as **CHILD NATURE I - XIII**, who are the generations of child-aged Mother Natures.

SECOND NATURE, teenage deity, Mother Nature's second child. Long after losing True to the fall of humanity, Mother Nature conceives them, naming them "second" as another chance. They are a quick learner yet rambunctious and hardly gets anywhere on time. The very last human Imara Truth becomes their godmother. Second Nature's arc is about breaking free from being a replacement to forge their own identity as an independent protector of life.

GOOD NATURE, shapeshifter animal, the loyal pet of Mother Nature for all generations. The first Mother Nature initially created them as a bacterium and evolved into any animal the succeeding Child Natures drew.

IMARA TRUTH, adult human, the very last human on Earth. To be in the good graces of Mother Nature, she agrees to give up her pursuit of finding other humans and to eventually go extinct. However, she seeks plans to get around it.

© Androgyny Ecology: Each character resembles the androgynous nature, with open-ended vocal requirements

© Queer People of the Global Majority most represent the experiences of nature; cast accordingly

MUSICAL NUMBERS

1. "Mom, I Made Earth"
2. "In My Image"
3. "Truth Be Told"
4. "Homos Got Morals"
5. "Give Me a Second"
6. "A Nice Run"
7. "Truth Be Bold"
8. "Life Goes Out, Light Stays On"